Maybank

STRATEGY

Regional

ASEAN+ FORTNIGHTLY

Highlights (16 – 27 March, 2026)

Malaysia: Stagflation headwinds weigh on GDP, CPI; UEMS MK upped to BUY; DLG MK, ITMAX MK see TPs revised higher

The Middle East (ME) conflict has unleashed a stagflationary shock on the world, and while Malaysia's status as a net energy exporter (1.1% of GPD in 2025) will help cushion the economy, second-order impacts from higher prices for electricity, fuel and industrial/food supply chain inputs will be a drag – our macro team has duly moderated 2026/27 GDP growth forecasts to +4.9%/+4.7% (from +5.1%/+4.7% previously), while raising 2026/27 headline inflation forecasts to +1.8%/+2.1% (+1.7%/+1.9%). Preferred market positioning in the current uncertain environment is domestic-focused, including leveraging the resilient investment upcycle (GAM, SDG, MNH), RE (TNB, SOLAR) and defensives (IHH, WPRTS, ECOSHOP), with ME-related trading appeal noted re **PMETAL** and **PCHEM**. We upgrade UEM Sunrise to BUY following recent price weakness, with concerns over execution now appearing largely priced in – at current prices, the property developer is trading at an undemanding 0.3x/0.28x PBV/PRNAV, despite its sizeable ≈4,500-acre landbank (worth MYR58.6b in GDV) in Iskandar Puteri, which stands to benefit from rising land values and sustained demand in JS-SEZ. We lift O&G top pick Dialog's FY26-28E EPS by 7-13% after imputing our higher in-house Brent crude oil price assumption to USD75/70/67 per barrel for 2026-2028E (from USD65/66/66) - with that, our SOP-TP is lifted by 7 sen to MYR2.28. SMID pick ITMAX also sees upgrades re earnings (raising FY26-28E forecasts by 5-6%) and TP (lifted to MYR5.83, from MYR5.67) following acceptance of a 15-year Letter of Appointment (LoA) awarded by Majlis Bandaraya Johor Bahru (MBJB) to serve in the capacity of a smart parking operator (revenue sharing model) for on-street parking within MBJB's jurisdiction.

Singapore: Resilient vis-à-vis energy crisis; initiate on SATS SP; STE SP upgraded to BUY; AEM SP, GRAB US see TPs upped

Stagflationary reverberations from the Iran conflict mean we have trimmed FY26 GDP growth to +3.4% (from +3.6%) and raised FY26E/FY27E inflation forecast to +1.8%/+2.0%, respectively (from +1.6%/+1.8%). Due to Singapore's large fiscal reserves, we believe the country will be relatively better positioned to weather the crisis. We are POSITIVE Consumer, Internet, Property & REITs, SMIDs, Manufacturing, Tech, Telecom; NEUTRAL Banks, Gaming, Healthcare, Industrials, Plantations, Transport. **Top picks**: DBS, Sea, SGX, CSE, ISOTeam, CDLHT, LREIT, Coliwoo, Singtel, ST Engineering, FCT and ADDV. Initiate coverage of SATS SP with a BUY rating, underpinned by dominant positioning in both gateway services and food catering which positions the company to capture rising demand across EMEA and ASEAN. We upgrade STE SP to BUY on the improved outlook for defence and commercial aerospace revenue growth. We raise AEM SP TP to SGD4.84 based on a higher 32x FY26/27E P/E (25x previously) following a strategic partnership with ASE to accelerate its AI/HPC test innovation. We also raise GRAB US TP to SGD6.48 on proposed USD600m acquisition of foodpanda Taiwan, a structurally attractive on-demand market, and raising food delivery GMV estimates by 4-10%.

Indonesia: BI on hold; High energy prices boost coal outlook

Bank Indonesia (BI) held its policy rate at 4.75% for a sixth consecutive month, prioritising rupiah stability amid rising global risks. In a hawkish shift, BI removed guidance on further rate cuts, signaling a hold-for-longer stance. Indonesia is targeting up to Rp80tn (~US$4.7bn) in savings to cushion the economic fallout from the ME conflict (details pending). The government has reiterated key spending priorities remain intact, including flagship free meals programme (US$19.7bn in 2026) and fuel subsidies, which cover 30-40% of consumer costs and account for c.15% of the budget. Authorities are also exploring fuel-saving measures — such as one day of remote work per week for selected public sector workers — while also allowing coal miners to boost production to capitalise on higher prices amid global energy crunch. Against this backdrop, we continue to favour coal names such as ITMG and UNTR; also AADI, PTBA. We see scope for similar policy relaxation to extend to nickel miners, although we would adopt a more cautious entry approach for names exposed to production quota constraints such as INCO and **NCKL**.

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ASEAN+: Top BUY ideas

Stock	BB Ticker	Price	TP	*Upside (%)*
Malaysia				
RHB Bank	RHBBANK MK	8.56	9.40	*15.4*
SD Guthrie	SDG MK	5.85	6.45	*10.3*
IHH	IHH MK	9.02	10.49	*16.3*
Solarvest	SOLAR MK	2.30	3.72	*61.8*
ViTrox	VITRO MK	4.30	5.88	*36.7*
Singapore				
DBS	DBS SP	57.12	65.31	*14.3*
Sea Ltd	SE US	79.85	127.00	*59.1*
SGX	SGX SP	19.52	20.37	*4.4*
ISOTeam	ISO SP	0.08	0.12	*57.9*
CSE Global	CSE SP	1.21	1.52	*25.6*
Indonesia				
Indo Tambang	ITMG IJ	29,500	33,500	*13.6*
United Tractor	UNTR IJ	30,800	31,500	*2.3*
Adaro Andalan	AADI IJ	10,975	12,500	*13.9*
Astra Internat	ASII IJ	6,250	6,700	*7.2*
Vale Indonesia	INCO IJ	5,600	8,000	*42.9*
Thailand				
WHA	WHA TB	4.18	4.80	*14.8*
Amata	AMATA TB	19.00	25.00	*31.6*
Ch Karnchang	CK TB	14.50	23.00	*58.6*
Global Power	GPSC TB	32.00	50.00	*56.3*
Airports of TH	AOT TB	50.75	60.00	*18.2*
Philippines				
PLDT	TEL PM	1,295	2,000	*54.4*
SM Prime	SMPH PM	19	40	*107.0*
Jollibee	JFC PM	184	311	*69.4*
Globe	GLO PM	1,634	2,000	*22.4*
Puregold	PGOLD PM	40	49	*24.1*
Vietnam				
Asia Com Bank	ACB VN	23,600	30,846	*30.7*
MBB Bank	MBB VN	25,800	32,500	*26.0*
Mobile World	MWG VN	78,500	102,000	*29.9*
Hoa Phat	HPG VN	25,900	37,220	*43.7*
Gemadept	GMD VN	77,800	87,600	*12.6*

Source: Maybank IBG Research, Factset 26 Mar

See next page for
Thailand, **Philippines** & **Vietnam**

Thailand: This too shall pass; CCET TB has TP moderated

We maintain our POSITIVE view on the SET and keep our YE26 index target unchanged at 1,500 based on 16x target P/E. While the war in Iran presents downside risk to our outlook, our analysis suggests Thailand can cope with the current energy crisis. While Thailand relies heavily on Middle East oil & gas imports, existing reserves, supplies from other areas, higher domestic output, export controls and increased use of renewable fuels mean the country will be able to manage the supply crunch. In terms of prices, a combination of Oil Fund and potential subsidies from state-owned companies (EGAT, PTT) will enable the government to slow the price rises for at least 4 months, on our estimate. Beyond that, the government may have to resort to using its budget for direct subsidies. Thailand also starts out with very low inflation and could tolerate more price increases than other economies. On the economic front, MIBG has downgraded Thai GDP growth to +1.8%, from +2.1%, for 2026. However, we see private investment and public infrastructure spending as bright spots for the economy. The incoming Anutin government will likely maintain its focus on these areas as they form the core of its Economic Revitalization Plan. The government targets +3% GDP growth with an investment-to-GDP ratio of 30%, up from about 20% currently. Now that politics is stable, we also expect the pace of infrastructure spending to accelerate with potential for public project tenders of up to THB1.1t in 2026-28E, up nearly 6-fold from 2023-25.

Our top stock picks centre around three themes. The first group is policy winners as they will likely benefit from the government's push for higher private investment and infrastructure spending: **WHA**, **AMATA** and **CK**. The second group of top picks are post-war beneficiaries— **GPSC**, **AOT** and **MINT**. These stocks have seen large corrections due to the potential war impacts but could quickly reverse course if the war were to end as our base case remains weeks-long rather than a months-long conflict. Last, we like selected domestic exposure to resilient companies that are well protected from the impact of the war but nonetheless have seen corrections along with the market. These are **SPALI** and **TRUE**. For **CCET**, we maintain BUY on CCET, but lower our TP to THB6.5 to reflect higher interest expenses and lower sales. Our BUY is supported by FY26E and FY27E core profit growth of 19% and 22%, driven by sales growth and GPM expansion from new deals, as well as lower other expenses.

Philippines: Energy price surge, weak peso stoke inflation risks; downgrade market to underweight despite attractive valuation

The PSEi declined 3.0% over 10–24 Mar, as the peso weakened to PHP60/USD and oil prices surged. Retail pump prices jumped over 60% in less than three weeks, amplifying inflation concerns. Escalating US–Iran tensions raised fears of prolonged supply disruptions, fueling stagflation risks and speculation of policy tightening. While Bangko Sentral ng Pilipinas (BSP) signaled readiness to curb FX volatility, a rate hike has not been ruled out if oil-driven inflation persists. We raise our inflation forecast to +3.3%, assuming every 10% increase in oil adds 0.45ppt to CPI, and now expect sub-5% GDP growth for FY26–27E. That said, we still see the BSP pausing for the rest of the year, while President Ferdinand Marcos Jr. declared a one-year energy emergency and secured authority to cut fuel excise taxes to cushion the shock. On the earnings front, 24 index stocks have released results: 14 in-line, 5 ahead, 5 behind (current earnings growth: c.6% vs ours at 8%).

From the onset of the conflict (see *Before Midnight* report), the market has corrected -9%, bringing valuations to 8.8x FY26E P/E and highlighting emerging deep value. **ALI** trades at a steep 74% discount to NAV, while banks (**BDO**, **BPI**) are below 1x fwd P/B. REITs (**AREIT**, **RCR**) offer >7% yields, and elevated transport costs could favor stay-at-home plays such as telcos (**PLDT**, **CNVRG**). While near-term risks persist as inflation has yet to fully feed through, current dislocations present opportunities to accumulate quality names *(see Snippets from Invest PH, Opportunities arise report)*. In our recent ASEAN strat report, we downgrade PH to Underweight given oil import dependence and remittance risks, and prefer defensives, highlighting **TEL**, **PGOLD**, **JFC**, and **GLO**, alongside other top picks aka "Magic 8": **SMPH**, **BDO**, **SM**, and **AREIT**.

Vietnam: ME tension is resulting in broadening impacts on the macro outlook; lower 2026 GDP growth forecast to +7.2%

The VN-Index has experienced a rapid -13% correction following the start of the ME conflict, and appears to be searching for an equilibrium point after an intense period of risk-off sentiment. However we believe macroeconomic conditions are not yet conducive to a sustained recovery. The VND has depreciated against the USD, with black market rates recently touching the 28,000 mark, representing a -5% YTD decline. 12M deposit rates have surged by 50–100bps, now ranging between 6.5% and 7.0%. These, coupled with the looming threat of energy supply chain disruptions, continue to cloud the outlook. Given the lack of visibility regarding a diplomatic resolution to the conflict, our internal assessment is shifting from a moderate "even-downturn" toward a more structural “cyclical downturn”. Our GDP growth forecast for 2026 is lowered to +7.2%, from previous +7.6%. We have identified two primary paths for the VN-Index through FY26. In our Base Case, which assumes the conflict is resolved by April, we expect GDP growth to remain resilient at 7%–8% with CPI contained between 4% and 4.5%, supporting a +16% corporate earnings growth for 2026, justifying a VN-Index target of 2,000 points. However, risks toward our Bear Case is increasing, where a prolonged conflict lasting until mid-year could stifle growth to 2%–3% and push inflation toward 6%–7%. In such a scenario, corporate earnings could contract by 5%–10%, leading us to revise the VN-Index target down to 1,500 points. On a separate note, following the conclusion of the 2nd Central Committee Plenum, the next key milestones on the market's radar are the May general elections and the July appointments of key government officials, both of which will be instrumental in shaping market sentiment for the 2026–2031 term.

Amidst heightened uncertainty, our stock selection remains tactical and sensitive to ongoing geopolitical developments. Within the banking sector, valuations are currently pricing in a cyclical downturn; however, there remains potential for a further 12%–15% discount should this scenario be fully realized. In our Base Case, we favor **MBB**, **ACB**, **HDB**, and **EIB**/**STB**. Conversely, for a Bear Case, we prioritize **MBB**, **ACB**, and **EIB**. Beyond financials, we remain bullish on **HPG**, **GMD** and **MWG**. We also view the recent sharp sell-off in **PNJ** as a compelling buying opportunity, as the market’s concerns regarding an investigation appear overblown. We pick **SSI** for market upgrade theme while we maintain a less bearish view on the real estate sector, specifically favoring **NLG** and **KDH**. Re energy, **BSR** and **PVS** remain our top picks given the current macro tailwinds.

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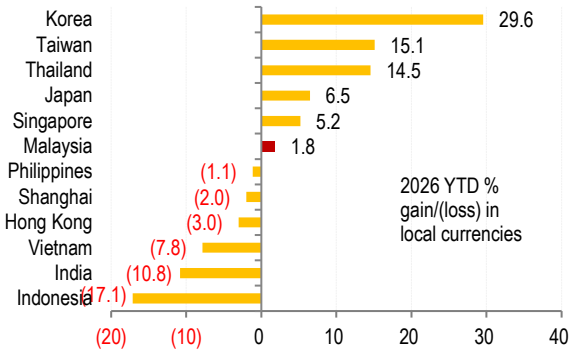
ASEAN+: regional dashboard

Fig 1: ASEAN: regional market valuations

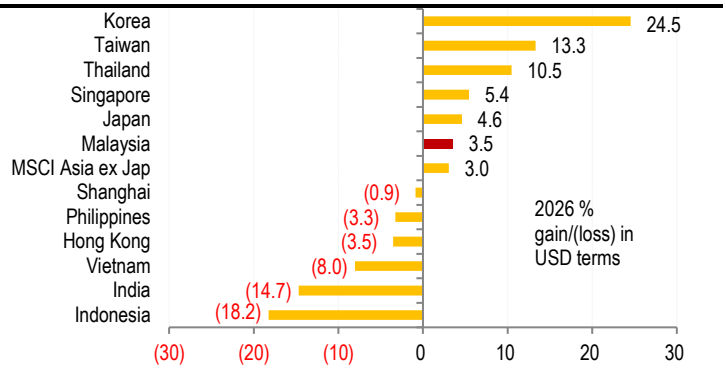
	Index	PER (x)		Growth (%)		ROE (%)		P/B (x)		Yield (%)	
		2026F	2027F	2026F	2027F	2026F	2027F	2026F	2027F	2026F	2027F
Malaysia	1,711	14.9	14.1	6.9	5.8	10.4	10.6	1.6	1.5	4.2	4.4
Singapore	4,888	15.9	14.3	6.3	10.7	12.0	12.6	1.9	1.8	4.7	4.9
Indonesia	7,164	11.5	10.1	13.3	11.4	0.7	0.7	0.1	0.1	6.0	6.5
Thailand	1,443	15.2	14.3	6.7	5.3	8.4	8.8	1.6	2.2	3.1	3.3
Philippines	5,984	8.9	8.2	9.1	8.5	14.2	14.2	1.4	1.3	3.5	3.7
Vietnam	1,645	11.8	10.0	14.8	16.3	13.8	13.8	1.6	1.4	2.3	2.6

Source: Maybank IBG Research, MSCI, Bloomberg 26 Mar 2026

Fig 2: Asia: market performance (benchmark indices)



Source: Bloomberg (as of 26 Mar 2026), Maybank IBG Research (chart)



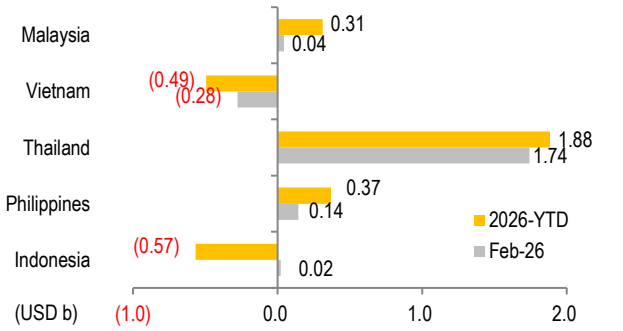
Source: Bloomberg (as of 26 Mar 2026), Maybank IBG Research (chart)

Fig 3: ASEAN: index targets, earnings and sector weightings

	Index (pts)	End-2026 target (pts)	Up/(Downside) %	Basis / Earnings growth / Overweights (OW) / Underweights (UW)
Malaysia (KLCI)	1,711	1,780	+4.0%	15.5x 2027E forward PER, slightly above historical mean (15x); MIBG 25/26E/27E KLCI earnings growth at +5.1%/+6.0%/+7.7%, respectively. OW: Banks, Consumer, Construction, REITs, Healthcare, Renewable Energy (RE), Ports, Aviation; N: Property, Plantations, Telcos, Utilities, Tech, Auto, Gloves, O&G; UW: Petrochem.
Singapore (STI)	4,888	5,600	+14.6%	Pegged to 5-year mean forward PE +2SD of 17.1x. OW: Non-Bank Financials, Consumer, Internet, REITs, SMIDs, Tech. Manufacturing, Telecom; N: Banks, Gaming, Healthcare, Industrials, Plantations, Transport.
Indonesia (JCI)	7,164	9,250	+29.1%	12.0x forward 2026E P/E, implying -0.5SD vs. 10yr mean; MIBG 24A/25E/26F JCI earnings growth at +0.1%/+0.3%/+10.3%, respectively. OW: O&G, Coal, Healthcare, New Economy; N: Consumer, Automotive, Metals, Banks.
Thailand (SET)	1,443	1,500	+4.0%	YE2026 SET Index target of 1500 based on 16.0x 2026E P/E (10Y avg.); Valuation is among cheapest in ASEAN, with SET trading on just 12.5x ex-DELTA, and with potential upside to our FY26F/27F EPS forecasts. OW: Energy, Telcos, Industrial Estate, Utilities, Property, Finance, F&B; UW: Commerce, Petrochem.
Philippines (PSEi)	5,984	7,000	+17.0%	10.5x 2026E PER; Earnings Yield Spread vs 10YR at >400bps, 2026E earnings growth at +9%, respectively. OW: Telcos, REITs; N: Banks, Power/Utilities, Conglos, Consumer; UW: Gaming, Tourism.
Vietnam (VNINDEX)	1,645	2,000	+21.6%	14.5x forward PER, 5yr mean; MIBG FY24A/25E/26E market earnings growth at post-tariff +19.0%/+20.5%/+17.5%; OW: Energy, Infrastructure/Construction, Natural Resources, Capital Market Development (Big Banks and Brokers), SOE divestment plays, selective leading Retailers; N: Residential property, Beverage.

Source: Bloomberg (as of 26 Mar 2026), Maybank IBG Research

Fig 4: ASEAN: foreign net buy / (sell) comp



Source: Bloomberg, Bursa Malaysia, Maybank IBG Research

Fig 5: Relative Performance

		Performance (%)			Performance (%)		
		1M	3M	YTD	1YR	3YR	5YR
Benchmark Indices	MSCI Asia ex-J	(10.4)	3.6	3.0	28.1	48.2	9.3
	MSCI EM	(10.6)	3.7	3.1	28.0	49.0	10.8
	MSCI ASEAN	(8.1)	(1.5)	(1.2)	12.8	14.7	3.6
Malaysia	FBMKLCI	(1.7)	2.0	1.8	12.7	22.2	6.8
Singapore	FSSTI	(1.5)	5.4	5.2	23.3	52.1	54.8
Indonesia	JCI	(13.0)	(16.1)	(17.1)	10.7	5.9	15.6
Thailand	SET	(5.9)	14.6	14.5	21.2	(9.4)	(8.4)
Philippines	PCOMP	(9.7)	(1.3)	(1.1)	(2.9)	(9.4)	(8.6)
Vietnam	VNINDEX	(12.5)	(4.9)	(7.8)	24.0	57.1	41.5

Source: Bloomberg (as of 26 Mar 2026), Maybank IBG Research

MALAYSIA: strategy and macro highlights

Fig 1: Malaysia: market strategy and sector/stock positioning

Macro Highlights / Market Strategy:

- Bank Negara (BNM) maintained OPR at 1.75% at its latest March 2026 MPC meeting, and we We maintain view of stable OPR this year as BNM holds on to the "insurance policy" taken i.e. 25bps cut in July 2025 to support the domestic economy given the fresh rounds of trade uncertainties and geopolitical tensions following US Supreme Court ruling on Trump's tariffs and US/Israel-Iran war. BNM acknowledges the renewed heightened external uncertainties due to the evolving Middle East conflict in terms of duration and disruption. Re inflation, after 2025 headline and core inflation rates of +1.4% and +2.0% respectively, BNM reiterates headline inflation will stay moderate in 2026 (official forecast range: +1.3% to +2.0%; Feb 26 CPI at +1.4%) while core inflation is projected to be stable around its long-term average in the absence of excessive demand pressures. In the wake of the energy price shock due to the Middle East conflict, we have raised our MY 2026/2027 headline inflation forecasts to +1.8%/2.1% (from +1.7%/+1.9%).
- The 13th Malaysia Plan (13MP) 2026-2030 seeks to sustain GDP growth momentum (13MP: 4.5%-5.0% p.a.; 12MP: 5.1% p.a.) via resilient consumer spending and sustained investment upcycle, as well as continued reforms and restructuring to transform into a "value creation" and high-income economy, labour market policies to boost workers' income and strengthening governance. Five areas to monitor are **i)** Investment Upcycle (expect investment to GDP ratio to reach 23.4% by 2030, from 19.7% in 2022); **ii)** Worker/Household income (targeting 2030 employee's compensation share of GDP of 40% vs. 2024's 33.6%); **iii)** Fiscal Consolidation and Reforms (cutting budget deficit to GDP ratio to <3% is crucial to achieve Federal Government debt to GDP ratio of 60% by 2030); **iv)** Productivity, Efficiency and Innovation (targets higher labour productivity growth of 3.6% p.a. vs. 12MP's est 2.9% p.a.) **and v)** Governance Reforms (such as Government Procurement Act, Anti Rent-Seeking Law – aimed at strengthening public finance).
- Budget 2026 continues to focus on fiscal consolidation and economic restructuring & transformation in-line with Malaysia MADANI, targeting a lower budget deficit, at MYR74.6b/3.5% of GDP (2025E: MYR76.7b/3.8% of GDP) while at the same time supporting sustained real GDP growth momentum (2026F: 4.0%-4.5%; 2025E: 4.0%-4.8%). It was relatively "quiet" on major tax measures, limited to Carbon Tax introduction (details pending) and excise duties hikes on alcoholic beverages and tobacco products.
- BNM's 1H25 Financial Stability Review (FSR) notes that while business sector impaired loan ratio is stable at 3.1%, cost pressures will persist into 2H25, stemming from policies such as **a)** expanded SST scope, **b)** water and electricity tariff restructuring; **and c)** mandatory EPF contributions for foreign workers. Household (HH) debt expanded 5.9% end-June 2025, while aggregate HH debt-to-GDP and banking system HH debt-to-GDP ratios rose marginally to 84.8% and 70%, respectively (end-2024: 84.1% and 69.5%, respectively). HH impaired loan ratio remains a low 1.1% while financial buffer is ample per HH financial assets at 2.1x HH debt.
- Re key market-impacting developments, government policy roll-out has picked up: 2H23 saw the MADANI Economy Framework, National Energy Transition Roadmap and New Industrial Masterplan (2030); more recently, the National Semiconductor Strategy was announced in May 2024, while the Government Procurement Act was passed in Aug 2025, followed by RON95 petrol subsidy in Sept 2025. Further, the Johor-Singapore Special Economic Zone (JS-SEZ) agreement was signed in Jan 2025, with Johor-centric property, plantations, RE and construction plays in focus – we are seeing a steady roll-out of related fiscal and ease of business-related investment incentives, in partnership with Singapore. RE exports, per NETR ambitions, appears on track to kick-off in the near future following establishment of the Energy Exchange Malaysia (Enegem) platform to facilitate cross-border trading of RE.
- RE reforms are also progressing on the domestic front, with the Energy Commission cutting system access charges (SAC) under the Corporate Renewable Energy Supply Scheme (CRESS) and Community Renewable Energy Aggregation Mechanism (CREAM) programmes in Aug 2025. Resulting lower costs for corporate PPAs is expected to spur uptake among large power consumers, particularly data centres. RE projects momentum is also accelerating, with LSS5+ bidders shortlisted while maiden Battery Energy Storage System (BESS) award is expected by Oct. Finally, the 'GEAR-uP' MADANI Economy plan focuses on "high-growth high value" or HGHV industries such as energy transition and advanced manufacturing; each GLIC - Khazanah, KWAP, PNB, EPF, LTH and LTAT – have their own sector focus.

Sector/stock positioning:

- Prefer domestic sectors-oriented stocks, balanced with yield and ESG considerations i.e. **i)** Financials (**RHB, Hong Leong Bank, Public, AMMB, Allianz,**); **ii)** Construction (**Gamuda**); **iii)** Tech: **Frontken** (TSMC-led), ViTrox (ATE-centric) and **Greatech** (equipment for solar/EV); also EMS **(ATech, VSI); iv)** O&G (**Dialog**); **v)** Retail/Consumer (**Padini, Nestle, Carlsberg, Heineken, Farm Fresh, QL, Well Chip, MYNEWS, AEON, Eco-Shop**); **and v)** Tech/Software (**MYEG, ITMAX).** More selectively, **Sime Darby Guthrie, SOP** (Plantations), **Tenaga, MN Hldgs., MFCB** (Utilities), **Telekom** (Telco), **Sime Prop., UEMS** (Property), **AAX, CAPITALA** (Aviation), **IHH** (Healthcare), **Solarvest, Pekat, BMGreen, GENERGY** (Renewables), **Genting** (Gaming), **Westports** (Ports & Shipping), **BAuto** (Auto) as well as REITs (**Sentral, YTL, Pavillion, AXIS, Paradigm, Al-Salam**) and SMIDs like **CTOS, PGF Cap., CPE**.
- **SELLs: Astro, BFood, Lotte Chem, Tan Chong, 7-Eleven, PIE, Tan Chong, Swift** and **TH Plant.**

Source: Maybank IBG Research

Fig 2: Malaysia: Stock Recommendations

Stock	BBG	M.Cap MYRm	Rec	Price MYR	TP MYR	Upside %	EPS growth (%) 2026E	EPS growth (%) 2027E	P/E (x) 2026E	P/E (x) 2027E	ROE (%) 2026E	ROE (%) 2027E	P/B (x) 2026E	P/B (x) 2027E	Div Yld (%) 2026E	Div Yld (%) 2027E
Large caps:																
Public Bank	PBK MK	93560	Buy	4.82	5.55	15.1	6.7	5.9	12.1	11.5	NA	NA	1.5	1.4	5.0	5.2
Tenaga	TNB MK	83823	Buy	14.38	14.60	1.6	10.8	9.1	15.9	14.5	10.0	10.4	1.6	1.5	3.8	4.1
IHH	IHH MK	79702	Buy	9.02	10.49	16.3	14.1	23.1	30.8	25.0	8.1	9.4	2.5	2.3	1.4	1.6
SD Guthrie	SDG MK	40457	Buy	5.85	6.45	10.3	(6.2)	0.7	18.3	18.2	11.4	10.9	2.1	2.0	2.7	2.8
RHB Bank	RHBBANK MK	37338	Buy	8.56	9.40	9.8	5.4	5.0	10.6	10.1	NA	NA	1.1	1.0	5.6	6.0
Gamuda	GAM MK	23546	Buy	3.98	5.30	33.2	14.2	27.5	19.8	15.5	9.5	11.5	1.9	1.8	2.8	3.5
Nestle (M)	NESZ MK	22981	Buy	98.00	120.00	22.4	16.3	11.2	37.3	33.5	106.9	118.9	39.9	39.9	2.7	3.0
AMMB	AMM MK	22205	Buy	6.70	7.40	10.4	7.0	3.7	10.3	10.0	NA	NA	1.0	1.0	4.8	5.0
Westports	WPRTS MK	20192	Buy	5.90	6.74	14.2	20.0	7.1	16.8	15.6	27.0	26.9	4.5	4.2	4.5	4.8
Mid-small caps:																
Vitrox	VITRO MK	8141	Buy	4.30	5.88	36.7	33.9	17.8	45.6	38.7	14.2	14.9	6.5	5.8	0.5	0.6
Eco-Shop	ECOSHOP MK	7884	Buy	1.37	1.80	31.4	24.4	29.8	29.7	22.9	24.2	27.9	7.2	6.4	2.0	2.6
ITMAX	ITMAX MK	4927	Buy	4.77	5.83	22.2	32.1	17.3	39.9	34.0	20.9	20.8	8.4	7.1	0.6	0.7
Solarvest	SOLAR MK	2189	Buy	2.30	3.72	61.8	41.1	34.9	26.1	19.3	9.6	11.4	2.5	2.2	0.0	0.0
Paradigm REIT	PARADIGM MK	1537	Buy	0.96	1.36	41.7	88.7	9.2	12.6	11.6	7.2	7.9	0.9	0.9	8.1	8.8
MN Holdings	MNHLDG MK	1226	Buy	1.86	2.47	32.8	30.0	28.9	14.6	11.3	30.2	28.0	4.4	3.2	0.2	0.3

Source: Maybank IBG Research, Factset, 26 Mar 2026

Fig 3: Malaysia: Key macroeconomic Indicators

	2022	2023	2024	2025E	2026F	2027F
Real GDP (%)	**9.0**	**3.5**	**5.1**	**5.2**	**4.9**	**4.7**
Private Consumption (%)	11.4	4.6	5.1	5.2	5.2	5.1
Government Consumption (%)	5.6	3.4	4.7	6.6	4.6	5.1
Gross Fixed Capital Formation (%)	6.8	5.4	12.0	9.6	9.3	8.7
Exports of Goods & Services (%)	14.5	(7.9)	8.3	3.1	3.8	4.2
Imports of Goods & Services (%)	16.0	(6.8)	8.2	4.6	5.0	4.8
Current Account Balance (% of GDP)	3.2	1.1	1.4	1.6	1.5	1.5
Fiscal Balance (% of GDP)	(5.6)	(5.0)	(4.1)	(3.7)	(3.5)	(3.1)
Inflation Rate (%, period average)	3.4	2.5	1.8	1.4	1.8	2.1
Unemployment Rate (%, period average)	3.9	3.4	3.3	3.0	2.9	3.0
Exchange Rate (per USD, end-period)	4.40	4.59	4.47	4.06	3.95	3.80
10-Year Government Bond Yield (%, end-period)	4.00	3.80	3.85	3.45	3.35	3.50
Benchmark Interest Rate (% p.a., end-period)	2.75	3.00	3.00	2.75	2.75	2.75

Source: CEIC, Maybank IBG Research

SINGAPORE: strategy and macro highlights

Fig 1: Singapore: market strategy and sector/stock positioning

Market strategy:

- In ASEAN, Singapore accounts for the second-largest oil and gas flows from the Strait of Hormuz, and the largest diesel import dependency in ASEAN at 16%.
- We lower our GDP growth forecasts for the ASEAN economies in 2026, resting on a base case that oil prices retreat to lower levels and some form of ceasefire is declared by 2Q.
- We lower our Singapore's 2026F GDP forecast by 0.2%, and raise Singapore's 2026F and 2027F inflation forecast by 0.2%.
- This is largely due to its net energy importer status, with oil and gas trade deficit at -5.8% of GDP in 2024. However, impact from high energy prices to the SGD is cushioned by Singapore's large current account surplus position, amounting to 16.7% of GDP in 2025.
- Singapore's financial sector may benefit from safe haven flows as investors hedge risks from Dubai, and its role as an aviation hub could enable it to benefit from higher transit traffic, as airlines find alternative routes to Middle East hubs.
- Singapore is in a relatively stronger position to weather the economic fallout from the war, by virtue of its robust reserves of energy and fiscal resources.
- The Singapore government is expected to unveil targeted fiscal support measures to cushion the impact of the energy shock, utilizing ample fiscal space from the S$8.5bn surplus in Budget FY2026.
- For market sector weightings, we prefer sectors that are geared towards themes including safe haven flows, policy reforms, capital returns and growing AI demand: We are **POSITIVE** Consumer, Internet, Property & REITs, SMIDs, Manufacturing, Tech, Telecom; **NEUTRAL** Banks, Gaming, Healthcare, Industrials, Plantations, Transport. Top picks are a mix of large-cap and mid-cap companies that can benefit from structural reforms, higher trading volumes, potential rate cuts, US domestic exposure, and managing volatility. **DBS, Sea, SGX, CSE, ISOTeam, CDLHT, LREIT, Coliwoo, Singtel, ST Engineering, FCT and ADDV.**

Sector/stock positioning:

- Maintain **AEM Holding (AEM SP)** with BUY (TP raised to SGD4.84), raising our FY26/27 earnings forecasts by 19.5% and 44.2% with a higher TP of SGD4.84, based on a higher 32x FY26/27E P/E from 25x previously. This is due to a strategic partnership with ASE to accelerate AI/High Performance Computing (HPC) test innovation, which we expect will boost AEM's revenue and net margins in FY27E/28E.
- Maintain **Grab Holdings (GRAB US)** with BUY (TP raised to SGD6.48), raising our food delivery GMV estimates by 4-10% for FY26-28, while tweaking earnings forecasts by -7% to +2% to reflect both integration costs and longer-term EBITDA upside. An acquisition with foodpanda Taiwan gives Grab entry into a structurally attractive on-demand market with meaningful food delivery scale and long-term optionality in adjacent verticals. Near-term earnings are likely need to absorb integration, migration and fuel-related margin pressure.

Source: Maybank IBG Research

Fig 2: Singapore: stock recommendations

Stock	BBG	M.Cap	Rec	Price	TP	Ret.	EPS gr. (%)		P/E (x)		ROE (%)		P/B (x)		Div Yld (%)	
		USDm		SGD	SGD	%	26E	27E	26E	27E	26E	27E	26E	27E	26E	27E
BUY (Large Caps)																
DBS	DBS SP	125,822	Buy	56.63	65.31	15.3	5.1	4.9	13.8	13.2	15.9	16.0	2.2	2.2	5.9	6.5
Sea Ltd	SE US	44,285	Buy	78.31	127.00	62.2	-	-	-	20.7	17.5	20.8	3.8	3.0	-	-
SGX	SGX SP	16,101	Buy	19.23	20.37	5.9	21.1	12.2	27.9	24.9	30.5	30.5	8.4	7.4	2.4	2.6
Singtel	ST SP	63,411	Buy	4.92	5.25	6.7	18.0	14.1	27.8	24.4	12.0	12.1	3.0	3.0	3.4	3.6
ST Engineering	STE SP	26,275	Buy	10.77	12.50	16.1	20.1	13.7	32.8	28.9	35.7	34.5	11.1	9.3	1.8	2.0
BUY (SMID - M.Cap <USD5b)																
CSE Global	CSE SP	696	Buy	1.23	1.52	23.6	577.8	23.0	20.2	16.4	18.0	19.1	2.8	2.4	2.4	3.0
Frasers Centrept	FCT SP	3,500	Buy	2.20	2.60	18.2	0.8	0.8	17.9	17.7	4.8	5.0	0.9	1.0	5.6	5.6
LREIT	LREIT SP	1,411	Buy	0.55	0.74	35.8	3.2	8.3	15.1	14.0	3.9	3.8	0.7	0.7	6.8	7.5
Coliwoo	COLIWOO SP	186	Buy	0.50	0.74	49.5	(97.7)	26.5	10.1	8.0	12.4	12.2	1.0	1.0	5.1	6.1
CDL Hospitality	CDREIT SP	796	Buy	0.80	1.00	25.0	57.1	1.0	14.5	14.5	3.2	3.4	0.5	0.5	6.8	6.9
Addvalue Tech	ADDV SP	233	Buy	0.08	0.12	48.1	83.9	97.0	63.3	31.6	40.5	49.8	19.9	12.0	-	-

Source: Maybank IBG Research, FactSet

Fig 3: Singapore: Key macroeconomic Indicators

	2022	2023	2024	2025E	2026F	2027F
Real GDP (%)	**4.0**	**1.5**	**5.3**	**5.0**	**3.4**	**2.9**
Private Consumption (%)	9.7	3.7	5.8	3.9	3.6	3.6
Government Consumption (%)	(2.5)	1.1	7.9	1.7	3.0	3.0
Gross Fixed Capital Formation (%)	2.2	(0.8)	6.3	6.1	5.8	5.6
Exports of Goods & Services (%)	5.3	4.4	5.7	10.8	4.7	5.5
Imports of Goods & Services (%)	6.2	4.1	6.7	11.9	4.6	5.8
Current Account Balance (% of GDP)	18.9	16.4	17.2	16.7	16.4	16.5
Fiscal Balance (% of GDP)	0.3	(0.4)	0.8	1.9	0.9	0.7
Inflation Rate (%)	6.1	4.8	2.4	0.9	1.8	2.0
Unemployment Rate (%)	2.1	2.0	2.0	2.0	2.1	2.1
Exchange Rate (per USD, end-period)	1.3395	1.3203	1.3657	1.2854	1.2500	1.2300
10-Year Government Bond Yield (%, end-period)	3.09	2.71	2.75	2.0	1.75	1.90
3M SORA (% p.a., end-period)	3.10	3.71	3.07	1.2	0.85	0.7

Source: CEIC, Maybank IBG Research

INDONESIA: strategy and macro highlights

Fig 1: Indonesia: market strategy and sector/stock positioning

Macro Highlights / Market Strategy:

- Compared to 10th of March, the JCI Index weakened by -4.49% to 7,106, mainly dragged by conglomerate-linked stocks **BREN** (-18.9%), **DSSA** (-20.8%), **TPIA** (-10.9%), **MORA** (-25.0%), **BRPT** (-9.7%), **CUAN** (-11.8%), **VKTR** (-17.2%), **PTRO** (-15.3%), **BUMI** (-14.2%), **BNBR** (-21.0%), **BUVA** (-10.9%), **RLCO** (-25.1%), **CDIA** (-6.6%), **COIN** (-13.0%), **RMKE** (-4.8%), **DEWA** (-14.4%), **RATU** (-9.9%), the big banks **BBRI** (-2.25%), **BMRI** (-3.67), **BBCA** (-2.87%), **BNLI** (-22.15%), **BRIS** (-4.52%) , and metals names **AMMN** (-20.5%), BRMS (-20.5%), ANTM (-6.7%), **TINS** (-13.5%). On the other hand, JCI was supported by commodities such as **EMAS** (18.8%), **MEDC** (4.4%), **PSAB** (5.0%), **SSMS** (8.3%), **DWGL** (13.0%) and telecommunication names **EXCL** (3.9%), **EMTK** (8.9%), ISAT (4.9%), **SCMA** (8.9%), **TOWR** (2.6%), **TBIG** (9.5%), **MTEL** (4.9%).
- IDR depreciated against USD in the past two weeks, ending at 16,985 on the 17th of March.
- Indonesia's sovereign bond rose across the board in the past two weeks: 3M to 1Y at the range of 46.1bps to 47.9bps, 2Y to 5Y at the range of 51.3bps to 49.6bps, 6Y to 10Y at the range of 23.7bps to 46.0bps, and 12Y to 30Y at the range of 4.7bps to 16.4bps.

Sector/stock positioning:

- **Banking**: We maintain **POSITIVE** on the banking sector despite remaining challenges and macroeconomic headwinds. With liquidity conditions improved we expect lending to grow faster in FY26E, albeit at a lower yield. However, the dropping rates for funding should offset the lower yields and mitigate the contracting margins. On the other hand loan demand seems lacklustered, as loan growth will depend on multiple factors such as commodity windfalls, government program transmission and interest rates trajectory. Nevertheless, banks will likely offer dividend in late 1Q26E to early 2Q26E, providing short-term buffer for share price performance.
- **Consumer & Cigarette**: Our NEUTRAL sector rating is unchanged (Staples: **POSITIVE**, Cigarette: **NEUTRAL**, Retailers: **NEGATIVE**) with Top BUYs (in order): 1) **ACES**; 2) **KLBF**; 3) **MYOR** and Top SELLs (in order): 1) **GGRM**; 2) **UNVR**; 3) **LPPF**. In our view, the on-going US-Iran war will produce sentiments, which will present (i) upside risks to oil (supply crunch) and palm oil (potential B40-B50 implementation) prices; (ii) downside risks across soft commodities (global growth slowdown); and (iii) risks to meaningful IDR depreciation against world's major currencies (trade balance concerns). Considering these ramifications, we stick to our Top BUYs as these names fulfil our preferences, which are 1) domestic-heavy business; 2) structural shift to China supply-chain (reduces USD-based cost exposure); and 3) low-PER and high dividend. Meanwhile, our SELL-rated **LPPF** and BUY-rated **ROTI** are slated for dividend payment in April 2026 with **LPPF's** and ROTI's dividend yield of 13.4% (*announced*) and 6.3% (*expectation*). This may open up a tactical short-term buying sentiment for **LPPF**.
- **Coal:** Thermal coal prices in 2025 are likely to remain under pressure, driven primarily by strong domestic production in China, which continues to cap import demand. China, accounting for over 50% of global coal consumption, has maintained output above 4.6b tons annually, with steady policy support to ensure energy security through domestic supply. This has significantly reduced the country's reliance on seaborne coal, particularly impacting prices for 4,200–5,000 kcal/kg grades from Indonesia. On the supply side, Indonesian exports remain resilient at over 500m tons per year, despite weather-related disruptions in Kalimantan. The combination of ample Chinese supply and steady export volumes from key producers has kept the market well-supplied, putting a ceiling on benchmark Newcastle coal prices. Without a significant cut in Chinese output or a demand shock from seasonal power needs, thermal coal prices are unlikely to see sustained upside. We prefer names that offers high production growth and generous dividend yield for this sector such as **AADI** and **ITMG**.
- **Metal:** Nickel prices are expected to stay under pressure throughout 2025, weighed down by persistent global oversupply. The situation has become more challenging for Indonesian nickel producers following the implementation of a new progressive royalty structure, which raises the minimum royalty threshold compared to the previous regime. In contrast, the outlook for gold remains highly favorable which supported by rising geopolitical risks, intensified U.S. trade policies, and robust demand from global central banks. Given this backdrop, we see stronger upside potential in names with meaningful gold exposure. We prefer **INCO** due to expectation higher nickel ore sales volume and **BRMS** which are well-positioned to benefit from the ongoing strength in the gold market.
- **Telco:** FY25 net income was mixed, with Indosat beating our expectations (at IDR5.5t vs. IDR4.9t, driven by higher revenue), while **EXCL** missed at IDR4.4t (vs. IDR3.7 t, due to higher opex). Meanwhile, Telkom is likely to release in April. We note that the competition is pivoting to network quality, as operators start operating 5G BTS: **ISAT** at 6,872 and EXCL at 4,864 in FY25E, while Telkomsel (subsidiary of **TLKM**) at 4,009 per 9M25. We like **EXCL** as our Top pick in the sector.
- **Media:** Google, Temasek, and Bain & Company are projecting that digital media consumption in Indonesia will increase by 16% YoY to USD9b in FY25 and reach USD15b by 2030. We view cheaper, faster internet connections as the main drivers, as consumers now prefer digital content for its diverse, engaging stories. Meanwhile, TV will continue to be the primary source of free entertainment, with TV drama and sporting events as the primary catalysts.
- **Infrastructure:** Jasa Marga to issue IDR2.06t bonds: IDR281.2b Series A (3-Year, 5.7%), IDR718.2b Series B (5-Year, 6.15%), and IDR300b Series C (7-Year, 6.5%), and IDR767.7b Series D (10-Year, 6.75%). IDR1.3t of proceeds is for 1.3m shares of Jasamarga Japek Selatan (JSMR will own 92.3%). Construction has reached 75.8%, and sections 2 and 3 will start operating in 2027, while section 1 will start operating in 2031.
- **New Economy**: Google, Temasek, and Bain & Company project GMV in Indonesia to grow 14% YoY to USD100b, with e-commerce GMV at USD71b (+14% YoY). Meanwhile, the on-demand service market size is at USD 10b (+13% YoY), while online travel is up 11% YoY to USD9b. We believe rising digitalization and economic momentum are the key drivers for long-term growth. We view GOTO as the most integrated local-tech platform in Indonesia, despite intense competition from foreign-based companies. We maintain our BUY Call on GOTO with TP of IDR120.
- **Automotive**: We remain cautiously optimistic with **NEUTRAL** call on Indonesia's auto sector. Domestic car market contraction in 2025 was deeper than we expected (2025 volume:-7% YoY) while the motorcycle market was flattish (+1% YoY). We expectto see moderate recovery catalysts (c.5% industry volume growth) in 2026:various new product launches, lower interest rates, and flagship government programs expected to lift domestic demand. 1M26 auto sales has shown encouraging sign (4W: +7% YoY, 2W: +3% YoY). We prefer **AUTO** as our Top Pick as we see an attractive 1) valuation, 2) dividend yield, and3) earnings growth (7% 3-year CAGR) on the back of market share expansion, and margin improvement from automation and EV localisation.
- **Healthcare:** We maintain a **POSITIVE** outlook for the Indonesian healthcare sector, with BUY recommendation for all the hospital counters under our coverage and **MIKA** as our top pick. Indonesia's healthcare sector remains one of the most defensive plays in the challenging macro backdrop. With revenue driven by domestic demand, minimal exposure to external trade and IDR depreciation risks, and non-cyclical service consumption, the sector offers earnings resilience amid rising volatility. Major hospital

operators (MIKA and SILO) continue to demonstrate strong free cash flow (FCF) generation, while HEAL is forecasted to improve profitability as it continues to increase private patient mix and benefitted from synergy with minority stakeholder Astra and Djarum groups. This positions the sector as a safe haven relative to others, amid external headwinds, including tariff shocks and FX volatility.

- **Property:** We are POSITIVE on the sector due to attractive valuation while fundamentals remain robust. FY25 aggregate pre-sales (ex-JV land sales) were down by 7% YoY following a strong period of strong outperformance (+13% CAGR over FY20-24). Looking ahead, we expect pre-sales momentum to improve in FY26E, supported by a robust launch pipeline. BSDE plans to roll out two new proejcts ('Nava Park 2' and 'Kota Wisata Ecovia'), CTRA is preparing to launch 'Citra Homes Halim' and 'Citra Bukti Golf', PWON continues its robust expansion pipelien through 2030, and SMRA stands to benefit from its flagship townships in Serpong alongside the ramp-up of its newest township in Tangerang. Current valuations are at the lowest level in the region, while yield remains attractive. PWON is our Top Pick due to its solid recurring income base, attractive yield and cheap valuation.
- **Cement:** Jan'26 cement demand rose by 11% YoY driven by strong bag demand while bulk remained soft. The pickup was supported by post-flood emergency-phase reconstruction in Sumatra, which should support volumes through 1Q26, with the broader rehab & reconstruction program rollout from Apr'26 providing a medium-term tailwind. Additional support could come from Red & White Cooperative and Giant Seawall project, posing upside risk to our conservative FY26E volume growth forecast of 2% YoY, which does not fully factor in these projects. We have a **POSITIVE** sector view, supported by attractive valuations and a decent yield of 2-4%. SMGR is our Top Pick, given its positioning as the primary beneficiary of government-led infrastructure projects.
- **Poultry**: Given the rising policy-driven uncertainty and a less supportive supply-costsetup, we downgrade our poultry sector view to **NEUTRAL** from **POSITIVE** and downgrade **CPIN** and **JPFA** to **HOLD**. The shift reflects: (i) a higher risk of broiler oversupply from the larger GPS quota; and (ii) feed cost inflation risk from the new soybean meal import routing through Berdikari, which may lift landed costs and compress margins. While we view that volume growth to remain strong due to flagship FMP and downstream consumer product expansion remain supportive, near- to medium-term risks now outweigh the positives.

Source: Maybank IBG Research

Fig 2: Indonesia: stock recommendations

BB Code	Mkt. cap (USDm)	Rec.	Price (IDR)	TP (IDR)	Upside (%)	EPS grw. (%)		PER (x)		ROE (%)		P/B (x)		Div. Yield (%)	
						FY26E	FY27E	FY26E	FY27E	FY26E	FY27E	FY26E	FY27E	FY26E	FY27E
BUY															
BBCA IJ	49,381	Buy	6,775	10,650	57.2	4.9	7.9	14.5	13.5	19.4	18.9	2.7	2.4	0.0	0.0
BBRI IJ	31,185	Buy	3,480	4,900	40.8	10.4	13.5	8.6	7.6	18.2	19.6	1.5	1.4	9.3	10.6
BMRI IJ	26,102	Buy	4,730	6,000	26.8	5.9	8.5	7.4	6.8	17.6	17.9	1.3	1.2	10.5	11.4
TLKM IJ	17,864	Buy	3,050	3,900	27.9	-12.7	2.4	13.9	13.6	17.1	15.0	2.0	2.1	5.8	6.0
ASII IJ	13,883	Buy	5,800	6,700	15.5	3.3	3.2	7.0	6.8	11.7	13.4	0.9	0.9	6.4	6.6
BBNI IJ	9,681	Buy	4,390	5,000	13.9	10.9	12.2	7.4	6.6	12.3	13.0	0.9	0.8	8.8	9.9
AMMN IJ	8,977	Buy	4,630	11,000	137.6	0.0	26.7	6.4	5.0	24.2	24.1	23.3	18.3	0.0	0.0
PANI IJ	7,392	Buy	8,000	12,800	60.0	66.7	21.8	114.7	94.2	3.2	5.9	6.0	5.7	0.0	0.0
UNTR IJ	6,616	Buy	30,000	31,500	5.0	-6.9	0.0	6.0	0.0	20.5	0.0	1.1	1.0	8.9	8.3
BRIS IJ	5,755	Buy	2,110	3,350	58.8	21.4	21.5	10.3	8.5	17.0	18.2	1.7	1.5	2.9	3.5
ANTM IJ	5,328	Buy	3,750	4,500	20.0	-15.2	-1.8	13.7	13.9	23.0	20.5	2.9	2.9	5.3	5.3
HMSP IJ	5,021	Buy	730	975	33.6	6.5	18.2	9.4	7.9	25.9	67.2	3.2	3.0	8.3	10.7
ICBP IJ	4,896	Buy	7,100	14,000	97.2	33.0	14.0	7.2	6.3	19.7	21.8	1.6	1.5	6.1	7.3
AADI IJ	4,834	Buy	10,500	12,500	19.0	0.8	4.0	14.6	11.0	12.3	19.5	1.3	1.3	7.2	7.2
MDKA IJ	4,719	Buy	3,310	2,800	-15.4	2833.3	5.8	30.3	28.6	15.7	14.3	4.4	4.4	0.0	0.0
ADRO IJ	4,633	Buy	2,450	2,230	-9.0	31.9	0.0	11.0	0.0	4.7	0.0	0.5	0.0	3.1	0.0
ISAT IJ	4,098	Buy	2,150	2,500	16.3	-5.9	4.4	13.4	12.8	15.2	12.7	1.9	1.8	3.9	3.2
INCO IJ	3,275	Buy	5,575	8,000	43.5	175.4	56.0	13.2	8.5	8.3	11.7	1.0	1.0	0.0	0.0
GOTO IJ	3,185	Buy	51	120	135.3	130.9	31.2	64.7	49.3	1.1	3.1	1.7	1.6	0.0	0.0
BNGA IJ	3,137	Buy	1,785	2,400	34.5	9.3	9.6	7.1	6.4	12.7	13.1	0.9	0.8	0.0	0.0
INDF IJ	3,102	Buy	5,975	9,000	50.6	20.5	12.9	4.3	3.8	15.1	16.0	0.7	0.6	6.9	8.1
PGAS IJ	2,859	Buy	1,995	2,000	0.3	-34.2	5.0	12.7	12.1	9.3	8.1	0.8	1.0	9.4	9.0
KLBF IJ	2,730	Buy	985	1,450	47.2	9.6	13.5	11.5	10.1	14.7	16.1	1.9	1.7	3.3	3.7
MEDC IJ	2,675	Buy	1,800	2,500	38.9	255.0	21.4	4.9	4.0	22.4	22.2	1.0	1.0	-1.8	-1.8
MTEL IJ	2,643	Buy	535	850	58.9	-0.2	-5.8	19.9	21.1	6.4	6.0	1.3	1.3	3.3	3.0
MYOR IJ	2,432	Buy	1,840	3,000	63.0	-9.2	17.0	11.0	9.4	15.4	19.5	2.2	2.0	2.6	3.6
PGEO IJ	2,335	Buy	945	1,650	74.6	15.8	6.3	17.1	13.9	6.8	8.0	1.2	1.1	5.8	4.8
EXCL IJ	2,287	Buy	2,960	4,100	38.5	-113.1	620.0	110.7	15.4	-13.7	11.9	1.4	1.4	7.5	0.0
SILO IJ	2,073	Buy	2,700	2,500	-7.4	-18.1	16.1	30.4	26.2	15.5	12.4	3.6	3.4	1.1	1.1
ITMG IJ	1,871	Buy	28,000	33,500	19.6	-20.4	-11.2	10.9	12.3	8.7	7.6	0.9	0.9	7.2	7.2
MIKA IJ	1,731	Buy	2,080	3,000	44.2	10.8	10.9	21.0	19.0	18.4	18.5	4.1	3.7	2.0	2.2
AKRA IJ	1,501	Buy	1,265	1,850	46.2	6.0	9.4	9.9	9.0	21.1	22.5	2.1	2.1	4.1	4.1
TOWR IJ	1,442	Buy	478	880	84.1	12.5	5.7	6.7	6.4	14.1	12.3	0.9	0.8	3.3	3.3
AVIA IJ	1,423	Buy	390	500	28.2	3.3	7.0	13.4	12.5	18.2	19.0	2.5	2.4	5.5	5.8
JSMR IJ	1,330	Buy	3,100	4,500	45.2	4.6	8.5	5.9	5.4	10.4	10.2	0.6	0.6	5.0	5.0
HEAL IJ	1,159	Buy	1,325	1,700	28.3	10.5	36.9	36.3	26.5	7.9	9.7	3.0	2.7	0.7	0.8
ARTO IJ	1,135	Buy	1,385	2,600	87.7	116	64.8	32.3	19.6	6.5	9.8	2.0	1.8	0.0	0.0
INTP IJ	1,116	Buy	5,500	7,200	30.9	7.1	6.7	10.0	9.3	7.8	8.2	0.8	0.8	1.2	1.3

MAPI IJ	1,085	Buy	1,105	2,000	81.0	13.4	13.4	7.9	7.0	14.5	16.3	1.4	1.2	2.3	2.7
PWON IJ	951	Buy	334	580	73.7	4.5	12.7	6.4	5.7	11.1	10.9	0.7	0.7	2.5	2.9
BSDE IJ	920	Buy	735	1,050	42.9	4.8	1.4	7.0	7.0	5.0	4.7	0.4	0.3	0.0	0.0
SMGR IJ	888	Buy	2,520	3,400	34.9	165.5	24.9	18.4	14.7	0.7	2.1	0.3	0.3	0.3	1.2
CTRA IJ	752	Buy	685	1,300	89.8	5.1	-7.3	5.0	5.4	9.5	8.4	0.5	0.4	4.2	4.8
AUTO IJ	730	Buy	2,560	3,200	25.0	7.0	8.1	5.4	5.0	14.2	14.3	0.7	0.7	8.8	9.4
ACES IJ	387	Buy	382	750	96.3	9.8	29.0	7.3	5.6	13.3	16.8	0.9	0.9	8.0	8.7
SSIA IJ	342	Buy	1,230	1,500	22.0	41.5	0.0	8.7	0.0	9.6	0.0	1.1	1.0	1.2	1.7
SMRA IJ	332	Buy	340	640	88.2	-11.6	15.4	6.2	5.4	8.9	8.0	0.5	0.4	2.6	3.6
LPKR IJ	323	Buy	77	160	107.8	59.8	83.0	10.0	5.5	1.1	3.1	0.2	0.2	0.0	0.0
DRMA IJ	270	Buy	970	1,150	18.6	9.3	8.9	6.9	6.4	21.5	20.4	1.4	1.2	4.6	5.0
ROTI IJ	251	Buy	745	1,000	34.2	-25.6	12.7	11.7	10.4	10.4	13.7	1.5	1.4	6.3	8.6
MSTI IJ	244	Buy	1,315	1,900	44.5	9.3	8.8	6.7	6.2	24.9	23.5	1.8	1.6	7.3	7.3
KEJU IJ	186	Buy	560	850	51.8	28.5	20.1	14.5	12.1	24.2	27.8	3.8	3.5	4.5	5.2
MNCN IJ	183	Buy	206	550	167.0	9.3	5.9	2.4	2.3	5.3	5.6	0.1	0.1	3.4	3.7

Source: Maybank IBG Research, Bloomberg

Fig 3: Indonesia: Key macroeconomic Indicators

	2022	2023	2024	2025E	2026F	2027F
Real GDP (%)	**5.3**	**5.0**	**5.0**	**5.1**	**5.0**	**5.2**
Private Consumption (%)	4.9	4.8	4.9	2.5	4.9	5.1
Government Consumption (%)	(4.4)	3.0	6.6	5.1	6.0	5.4
Gross Fixed Capital Formation (%)	3.9	3.8	4.6	7.0	5.3	5.2
Exports of Goods & Services (%)	16.2	1.3	6.5	4.8	5.8	6.5
Imports of Goods & Services (%)	15.0	(1.6)	7.9	5.0	5.2	5.6
Current Account Balance (% of GDP)	1.0	(0.1)	(0.6)	(0.1)	(1.0)	(0.7)
Fiscal Balance (% of GDP)	(2.4)	(1.7)	(2.3)	(2.9)	(2.9)	(2.8)
Inflation Rate (%, period average)	4.2	3.7	2.3	1.9	3.3	3.0
Unemployment Rate (%, period average)	5.9	5.3	4.9	4.7	4.8	4.7
Exchange Rate (per USD, end-period)	15,568	15,399	16,132	16,690	17,000	17,000
BI Policy Rate (% p.a., end-period)	5.5	6.0	6.0	4.75	4.75	4.75

Note: Unemployment rate is released bi-annually, in February and August. Source: CEIC, Maybank IBG Research

THAILAND: strategy and macro highlights

Fig 1: Thailand: market strategy and sector/stock positioning

Market strategy:

- **Policy rates**: On 25 Feb, Bank of Thailand (BOT) cut its policy rate for the sixth time, to a 39-month low of 1.00% from 1.25%. The decision follows a split vote of 4:2. The move was unexpected as 20 out of 23 economists predicted that rates would stay on hold, on the back of positive GDP growth data in 4Q25 as well as emerging political stability. We expected the central bank to ease by 25 bps at its next meeting in 1Q26, then keeping the policy rate at 1.00% at end-2026.
- **Inflation**: Consumer Price Index (CPI) decreases unexpectedly widened to a 25-month low of -0.9% in Feb (vs consensus: -0.5%, Jan: -0.7%). Headline inflation did not rise as expected, because of weaker energy (-8.3%) and raw food (-1.2%) prices. Core inflation stayed unchanged at +0.6% for the third consecutive month, signaling muted underlying demand. Besides oil prices, the specter of prolonged conflict in the Gulf may be transmitted to the domestic economy via disruptions to the supply of energy, because around 60% of the kingdom's oil imports are from the Middle East. It could also result in higher import prices for consumer and producer goods especially amidst shipping disruptions. Inflation remaining below the BOT's target range of 1–3% supports expectations of further rate cuts, with our view that there will be one more rate cut this year. BOT shaved its 2026 headline and core inflation projections to +0.3% (from +0.5%) and +0.8% (from +0.9%) respectively, citing raw food and energy price weakness, and muted demand-side pressures. The central bank highlighted growing downside risks to headline inflation, due to the weakening outlook for global energy prices. It saw CPI inflation returning to the target range of between 1 and 3% only in 2H 2027, instead of 1H 2027 previously forecast. We lower our 2026 CPI inflation projection to 0% (from +0.4% previously), and continue to expect core inflation of +0.8% in 2026.
- **THB**: The baht, which strengthened against its trade-weighted basket of currencies by +13.3% since mid-2024, has crimped the export earnings of corporates. We expect THB to rise to 32.5 at the end of 2026E.
- **GDP growth**: Economic growth fell more sharply than expected in 3Q25 (+1.2% vs consensus: +1.6%, 2Q25: +2.8%), charting the weakest pace in four years. The deceleration came as resilient exports (+10.8%) only partly offset weakening domestic demand. Investment slowed significantly (+1.1% vs 2Q: +5.8%) while consumption stayed unchanged (+2.6%) amidst tepid consumer confidence. In nominal terms, GDP growth slid to +0.1% as economy-wide deflation persisted (-1.1%). GDP contracted -0.6% QoQ SA (vs consensus: -0.3%, 2Q25: +0.5%), the first decline since 4Q22. We maintain our GDP growth forecasts at +1.7% in 2026 and +2.5% in 2027, but remain alert to the downside risks to private investment and public spending from domestic policy uncertainty and the escalation of the border conflict with Cambodia. The BOT lowered its 2026 GDP growth forecast from the +1.6% projected at its Oct meeting, to +1.5%. It cited a private consumption slowdown due to softening incomes, alongside the impact of US tariffs on exports. The BOT raised its GDP growth forecast from 1.5% to around 2.0% for 2026. GDP growth in 2027 is projected to rise to +2.3%.
- **Current Account**: Improving tourism receipts and falling oil prices will help swing the current account into a surplus of 2.3% of GDP in 2024 improved from 1.5% in 2023.
- **Politics**: Thailand finally has a new PM, Mr. Anutin Charnvirakul. He achieved 311 out of 492 votes in the Parliament thanks to support from the main opposition party, People's Party, who voted in his favor in return for 3 main requests. These are: 1) the new PM must call for House dissolution within 4 months, 2) the new government must arrange for a national referendum on constitutional amendment, and 3) People's Party itself will not join the government but remain an opposition party. PM Anutin on 12 Dec called for a House dissolution and a snap election. This was due to disagreement with the opposition (particularly People's Party) on constitutional amendment. We expect Mr. Anutin to return as PM following next year's general election, expected in early Feb 2026. The latest election results (with 93% of the vote counted) show BJT receiving 194 out of 500 total MP seats, giving it a wide margin over the People's Party (PP) with 116 seats. This means BJT will lead the next government formation. We expect BJT to invite Pheu Thai (PT) with 76 seats, Democrats with 22 seats and 3 smaller parties totaling 12 seats to join the government. This would give the government a 304-seat majority in the parliament.
- **Strategy**: Given SET Index has already staged a strong rebound, we see limited near-term catalysts to push the index up much higher. We favour telcos and energy over banks; we remain cautious on retail and electronics.

Sector/stock positioning:

Below are details of our sector views, and top 12-month buys within each sector. The companies in **bold green** are our top buys.

- **Banks:** We like Bangkok Bank (**BBL TB**) for its well-diversified income, strong balance sheet, and compelling valuation. With a recovering capital position and ample loan-loss reserves, we assume the bank to gradual increase dividend payout ratio and maintain at least THB10.0 dividend per share in FY26-27E. BBL is likely to capture long-term growth through overseas operations, particularly Permata Bank in Indonesia.
- **Finance:** Consumer finance companies are likely to benefit from the policy rate cut in 2026. We expect cost of funds to gradual decline in 2026-27. We see upside catalysts for truck loan demand and expect improved asset quality. Our Top Pick are TIDLOR HOLDINGS (**TIDLOR TB**) and ASIA SERMKIJ LEASING (**ASK TB**).
- **Energy:** We upgrade our view on the Thai energy to POSITIVE from NEUTRAL as we factor in higher oil price (USD75/bbl in 2026E from 65 previously) and see potential upside for gross refining margin (GRM). The war in Iran has disrupted energy flows like we've never before seen and even as we assume the conflict will be resolved in weeks rather than months, we still expect energy prices to stay elevated as the market prices in added risk premium. PTTEP and BCP remain our Top Picks. We revised up our TP for PTTEP to THB157 from THB133, as we factor in higher oil price as well as 3-8% higher sales volume assumption. The stock remains attractive given its 8% volume growth in FY26E, cheap multiples (8x P/E, 1x P/BV) and 7% yield. BCP is our refinery Top Pick due to its cheap valuation (5x P/E, 0.7x P/BV) and unique positions to benefit from higher oil price due to its upstream unit.
- **Petrochemical:** We maintain our SELL rating for PTT Global Chemical (PTTGC TB, TP THB17). We expect the current petrochemical downcycle to be long-lasting given's China's drive for self-sufficiency amid lower demand growth. Higher ethane gas feedstock supply at a higher price (which gives PTTGC extra margins) in FY25E will be a net positive. However, this is not enough to for a major earnings turnaround, in our view.
- **Telcos:** We maintain a POSITIVE view on the telecom sector and prefer True Corp (**TRUE TB**, BUY, THB16.0 TP) over Advanced Info Service (ADVANC TB, HOLD, THB365 TP) thanks to TRUE's: i) higher FY26E core profit growth (TRUE 35% vs ADVANC 12%); and ii) cheaper valuation (based on FY26E P/E, EV/EBITDA and EV/OpFCF). For FY26E, we forecast core profit growth of 35% for TRUE vs 12% for ADVANC. Faster profit growth at TRUE should come from: i) larger spectrum cost saving (TRUE's THB5.3b pa vs ADVANC's THB2.4b pa); ii) opex decline (TRUE's -6% YoY vs ADVANC's +3% YoY); and ii) decrease in interest exp (TRUE's -9% YoY vs ADVANC's +18% YoY).

- **Construction materials and services:** We are positive on construction services. We believe Thai infrastructure is shifting from a period of stagnation to an investment super-cycle, with expected public project tenders of THB1.1t in FY26-28E, 6x higher than the past three-year cycle. We prefer Ch. Karnchang (CK TB) over Stecon Group **(STECON TB)** due to i) its cheaper valuation at 11x FY26E (vs STECON at 16x excl. special dividend from GULF) with stronger recurring income profile and ii) higher expected public project wins, which should drive stronger FY27-28E earnings growth of 6% (vs. 4% for STECON).
- **Automotive** Maintain NEUTRAL on Thai Autos. Ongoing Middle East conflict, accelerating domestic transition to Chinese EVs, and declining exports weigh down on Thai Autos. However, low CAPEX requirements and effective cost control allow Thai Autos to maintain FY26-28E dividend yields of >7%. Aapico Hitech (**AH TB**, BUY, TP THB15.4) for having secured Chinese EV customers (BYD and Changan).
- **Commerce:** We have raised MRDIYT's FY26-27E earnings forecasts on the back of strong FY26 sales momentum and maintain BUY, with a revised TP of THB10.60. QTD SSSG across most retail segments remains soft, with the exception of MOSHI, which continues to demonstrate robust growth. CPALL and MRDIYT posted slightly positive SSSG. We expect retail sector SSSG to improve in 2Q26E, supported by a low base effect, a rebound in tourist arrivals, and higher temperatures boosting sales of beverages and cooling-related products. In addition, the formation of a new government—expected in May—should help stimulate domestic consumption through policy stimulus measures. Our top picks are CPALL (**CPALL TB**) and MOSHI (**MOSHI TB**) given their resilient earnings profiles and strong ROE.
- **Agri, Food & Beverage:** Amid the weak economic outlook and stock market fluctuation, we designate Ichitan Group (**ICHI TB**) as our Top Pick in the beverage sector, supported by its high dividend yield of 8%, attractive valuation, and improving earnings outlook for FY26E. We expect ICHI's EPS to recover YoY from 1Q26 onwards (vs -14% in 2025), driven by stronger sales of new products and warmer weather conditions through FY26E. Among food names, we prefer i-tail Corp. (**ITC TB**) supported by its strong core EPS growth of 8% in FY26E, outperforming the average 5% decline among food companies under our coverage. This growth should be propelled by lower fixed transformation costs and increased benefits from Project Tailwind (its internal transformation project to reduce cost and boost OP) along with the continued growth in demand for pet food globally. We also like ITC for its most resilient business model to tolerate cost inflation in the sector.
- **Technology:** Maintain our NEUTRAL view on the tech-service sector with four BUYs (HUMAN, NETBAY, BBIK and SKY) and one SELL (BE8). Bluebik (**BBIK TB**, BUY, THB28.2 TP) is our Top Pick thanks to: i) expected core profit growth of 12% in FY26E; and ii) low FY26E P/E of 9x (vs sector average of 13x). Potential upsides to our forecasts for BBIK are M&A and JV deals.
- **Utilities:** We have a POSITIVE view on the power sector. we expect the new PDP to be released for public hearing this year, with a significantly higher new power capacity plan compared with the previous FY24 draft. Top Picks are BCPG (**BCPG TB**) and GPSC (**GPSC TB**). We favour BCPG as it has no direct exposure to LNG price volatility. We forecast BCPG's FY26 core profit to increase by 37% YoY, with an attractive FY26E P/E of 7.6x. For GPSC, we believe the recent share price correction has already priced in potential LNG price risks. We continue to see potential upside catalysts from: 1) possible SPP acquisitions within the PTT group; and 2) progress on Thai Oil's CFP project, which could lead to upside from incorporating the ERU project into our forecast.
- **Tourism:** We maintain POSITIVE for our tourism sector. We view the recent correction in tourism stocks as an opportunity to accumulate rather than to sell. In our base case scenario, in which the war lasts for three months, we expect Thailand tourist arrivals to decline by 1.4m, to 34m, in 2026. For hotels, the management of several listed operators finds it difficult to identify alternative markets. We maintain Airports of Thailand (**AOT TB**) as our top pick given limited impact from the ME tension, while it also has potential to become one of the beneficiaries from the increasing number of transit and transfer passengers as ME hubs will need time to restore confidence. We select Erawan Group (**ERW TB**) as our top pick among hotel stocks as it is expected to see strong growth in earnings contribution from HOP INN, coupled with an attractive valuation. Key downside risks include prolonged geopolitical tensions and the rising hotel supply in Bangkok.
- **Aviation:** We maintain a NEUTRAL view on the aviation sector, as we believe travel demand to Thailand will decline following the tension in the Middle East. Rising fuel cost is likely to suppress operating margin. Bangkok Airways **(BA TB)** remains our Top Pick among airlines given limited impact from the dispute in the Middle-East, its resilient passenger yield and attractive valuation with dividend buffer.
- **Healthcare:** We are NEUTRAL on the healthcare sector as we expect slow earnings growth of 3%, while the US–Iran war creates more uncertainty. Given the current uncertainty in Middle East patient flows, we recommend switching to Chularat Hospital (**CHG TB**, Buy, TP THB1.75) due to its least exposure to the Middle East at 2%. We expect FY26E earnings growth of 5%, while valuation remains attractive at 16x FY26E P/E. However, if Middle East uncertainty eases, we would recommend buying back Bumrungrad Hospital (BH TB, Hold, TP THB190).
- **Electronics:** Remain NEUTRAL on the sector as non-AI segments lack key recovery catalysts and due to continued tariff uncertainty. We like Cal-comp Electronics (**CCET TB**, BUY, TP THB6.5) for 19% FY26 core earnings growth, driven by i) mass production of two laser-printing customers; ii) new deals in the mobile POS segment; iii) continued HDD/SSD growth; and iv) lower Other Expenses (full closure of Chinese subsidiary). We also like Hana Microelectronics (**HANA TB**, BUY, TP THB27.5) for 69%/43% FY26/27 core profit growth, driven by lower losses at PMS/HTI and new AI customer.
- **Property:** We maintain our NEUTRAL view on Thailand's residential property sector, as we expect earnings to have bottomed in FY25 with a gradual recovery ahead, supported by our forecast of 12% aggregate net profit growth and 7% net presales growth in FY26. Our Top Pick is SPALI (**SPALI TB**), supported by strong net presales and earnings growth of 21%/30%, and an attractive dividend yield of 8%.
- **Industrial estate:** We are positive on the sector. We expect the FDI upcycle to continue in 2026–27E, driven by ongoing China+1 relocations, accelerating demand from data centres, and resilient traditional segments. The sector should also benefit from the government's effort to promote investment and accelerate approval processes. We maintain Buy on both WHA TB and AMATA TB, with **AMATA TB** as the top pick due to its stronger FY25-27E earnings growth of 10% CAGR and its cheaper valuation at 6x FY26E P/E.

Source: Maybank IBG Research

Fig 2: Thailand: Tactical Buys

Stock	BBg Code	Mkt. cap (USDm)	Rec.	Price (THB)	TP (THB)	Upside (%)	EPS grw. (%)		PER (x)		ROE (%)		P/B (x)		Yield (%)	
							25E	26E	25E	26E	25E	26E	25E	26E	25E	26E
WHA Corp	WHA TB	1,914	BUY	4.18	4.80	15	6.8	8.6	11.4	10.5	14.4	14.8	1.6	1.5	5.7	6.2
Amata Corp	AMATA TB	669	BUY	19.00	25.00	32	15.9	9.8	6.1	5.5	14.2	14.1	0.8	0.7	5.9	6.5
Ch. Karnchang	CK TB	799	BUY	15.40	23.00	49	-7.2	7.2	11.2	10.5	8.0	8.1	0.9	0.8	2.8	3.0
Global Power	GPSC TB	2,872	BUY	33.25	50.00	50	11.7	12.0	15.9	14.2	5.6	6.1	0.9	0.9	4.4	4.9
Airports of TH	AOT TB	22,315	BUY	51.00	60.00	18	-2.7	57.9	41.0	25.9	13.3	19.4	5.3	4.8	1.6	1.6
Minor Inter	MINT TB	3,890	BUY	22.40	30.50	36	17.2	5.8	12.8	12.1	11.8	11.5	1.3	1.2	3.5	3.6
True Corp	TRUE TB	14,921	BUY	14.10	16.00	13	35.2	14.5	19.0	16.6	31.3	33.1	5.5	5.5	3.7	4.2
Supalai	SPALI TB	987	BUY	16.50	21.60	31	30.1	4.0	6.0	5.7	9.5	9.5	0.6	0.5	8.4	8.7

Source: Maybank IBG Research, FactSet

Fig 3: Thailand: Key macroeconomic indicators

	2022	2023	2024	2025E	2026F	2027F
Real GDP (%)	**2.6**	**2.2**	**2.9**	**2.4**	**1.8**	**2.5**
Private Consumption (%)	6.3	6.7	4.4	2.7	1.9	2.9
Government Consumption (%)	0.1	(4.6)	2.6	0.6	1.8	2.0
Gross Fixed Capital Formation (%)	2.3	1.2	(0.3)	4.9	1.7	2.0
Exports of Goods & Services (%)	6.4	2.7	7.5	9.2	2.2	2.5
Imports of Goods & Services (%)	3.4	(2.5)	5.7	6.7	2.9	2.4
Current Account Balance (% of GDP)	(3.4)	1.6	2.2	3.1	2.0	2.0
Fiscal Balance (% of GDP)	(3.5)	(3.3)	(4.0)	(4.8)	(4.0)	(3.8)
Inflation Rate (%, period average)	6.1	1.2	0.4	(0.1)	0.8	1.2
Unemployment Rate (%, period average)	1.3	1.0	1.0	0.8	1.3	1.2
Exchange Rate (per USD, end-period)	34.6	34.26	34.10	31.51	32.50	31.00
Benchmark Interest Rate (% p.a., end-period)	1.25	2.50	2.25	1.25	1.00	1.00

Source: CEIC, Maybank IBG Research

PHILIPPINES: strategy and macro highlights

Fig 1: Philippines: market updates and sector/stock positioning

Market updates:

- The PSEi declined 3.0% over 10-24 Mar, as the peso weakened to PHP60/USD and oil prices surged. Retail pump prices jumped over 60% in less than three weeks, amplifying inflation concerns. Escalating US-Iran tensions raised fears of prolonged supply disruptions, fueling stagflation risks and speculation of policy tightening. While Bangko Sentral ng Pilipinas (BSP) signaled readiness to curb FX volatility, a rate hike has not been ruled out if oil-driven inflation persists. We raise our inflation forecast to 3.3%, assuming every 10% increase in oil adds 0.45ppt to CPI, and now expect sub-5% GDP growth for FY26-27E. That said, we still see the BSP pausing for the rest of the year, while President Ferdinand Marcos Jr. declared a one-year energy emergency and secured authority to cut fuel excise taxes to cushion the shock. On the earnings front, 24 index stocks have released results: 13 in-line, 6 ahead, 5 behind (current earnings growth: 5.5% vs ours at 8%).
- On the earnings front, 24 index stocks have released results: 14 in-line, 5 ahead, 5 behind (current earnings growth: c.6% vs ours at 8%).
- Foreign net outflow reached USD15.1m in 10 Mar - 24 Mar, (YTD net inflow: USD175.7m). The PSEi is currently trading below 9x PER, below the 10Y mean of 15.1x.
- **Positive catalysts:** Inflation is expected to remain within the BSP's 2-4% target, supporting further BSP rate cuts and consumption-led GDP growth driven by private spending and investment. A shift toward targeted subsidies over large infrastructure projects may provide near-term support to household demand. **Risks:** Growth could slow if government spending lags amid investigations and execution delays, while upside inflation risks from global food prices, import costs, and electricity pass-through persist. Heightened global and domestic uncertainties may weigh on trade, investment flows, and the PHP. Higher inflation due to high oil price amidst conflict in Middle East. Higher prices of goods can have a negative impact to consumer sentiment and spending.
- Market implications: Lower rates are supportive for banks, property, and consumption stocks but may pressure utilities and power. Progress in PPPs and capital market reforms could improve liquidity and valuations, with execution remaining key.

Sector/stock positioning:

- OVERWEIGHT: Power/utilities (windfall gains amid rising power prices), Telcos (clearer regulation, dividend play) and REITs (dividend play); NEUTRAL: Consumer (value and essentials-based consumption amid inflationary risks), Banks (potential challenges to NIMs and NPLs), Property (dampened domestic consumption, risk of elevated mortgage rates, weaker housing affordability), Ports (slower volume growth due to softer global trade conditions). UNDERWEIGHT on Tourism (tempered passenger volume), Gaming (regulatory overhang) and Conglos . Nonrated: Mining (clearer regulatory framework).
- Our top pick aka "Magic 8" are as follows: TEL, SMPH, JFC, SM, BDO, GLO, PGOLD and AREIT. *(see strategy report here).*
- We like TEL is positioned to strengthen its balance sheet in 2026 as capex declines to around PHP55b (vs ~PHP60b in FY25), supporting roughly PHP10b in free cash flow for deleveraging and sustaining an attractive ~7.6% dividend yield.
- SMPH is our Top Pick in the Property sector. 2026 growth is underpinned by continued mall expansion, expected residential pre-sales of ~PHP20b, and unlocking of its Pasay reclamation project, while trading at a 59% discount to NAV.
- JFC is our top pick in the consumer space. PH operations accounting for c.88% of NAV drive FY26E earnings growth of c.20%, with upside from faster Jollibee US franchise rollout and spin-off of international operations.
- We continue to like SM as the best proxy for the Philippine economy as the owner of the largest mall operator, largest retailer, and largest bank in the country. offers 8-9% FY26E earnings growth, supported by 130-140 net store openings, Alfamart expansion to c.2,300 stores, and recovery in retail and property segments.
- BDO is poised for 12-14% ROE in 2026, with sustained 12-14% loan growth and stable NIMs, while trading at just 1.0x FY26E P/B, implying potential re-rating.
- We expect GLO expected to deliver low-to-mid single-digit revenue growth with 2026e EBITDA margins in the low-50% range, while maintaining capex below USD1b, supporting positive free cash flow and a ~6% dividend yield.
- As a canned-goods manufacturer and low-end consumer staples player, PGOLD is likewise positioned to benefit from this sector recovery.
- AREIT should continue generating stable recurring income with portfolio growth potential and a dividend yield typically in the ~6-7% range, reinforcing its role as a defensive income play.

Source: Maybank IBG Research

Fig 2: Philippines: stock recommendations

	Bbg Code	Mkt. cap (PHPm)	Rec.	Price (PHP)	TP (PHP)	Upside (%)	EPS grw. (%)		PER (x)		ROE (%)		P/B (x)		Div. Yield (%)	
							FY25E	FY26E	FY25E	FY26E	FY25E	FY26E	FY25E	FY26E	FY25E	FY26E
PLDT	TEL PM	4,671	BUY	1,350.0	2,000.0	48.1	1.9	3.9	8.0	7.7	25.3	23.9	2.0	1.8	8.0	8.1
SM Prime	SMPH PM	9,364	BUY	19.2	40.0	108.3	6.4	5.5	11.8	11.2	10.3	10.1	1.2	1.1	2.4	2.6
Jollibee	JFC PM	3,424	BUY	182.5	311.0	70.4	21.1	16.8	16.4	14.1	17.4	18.0	2.4	2.2	2.4	2.9
SM Investments	SM PM	12,471	BUY	612.0	1,150.0	87.9	8.6	7.6	8.9	8.3	12.9	13.1	1.1	1.1	1.1	1.1
BDO Unibank	BDO PM	10,549	BUY	117.1	197.0	68.2	6.7	7.3	7.9	7.3	12.5	12.3	1.0	0.9	3.8	4.0
Globe	GLO PM	3,905	BUY	1,616.0	2,000.0	23.8	13.8	9.6	9.6	8.7	13.5	13.9	2.6	2.5	6.7	6.7
Puregold	PGOLD PM	1,886	BUY	39.8	49.0	23.3	6.2	7.4	9.9	9.2	10.5	10.5	1.0	1.0	4.6	3.0
AREIT Inc	AREIT PM	2,391	BUY	38.6	46.0	19.3	5.2	6.2	14.8	14.0	15.1	14.7	1.2	1.2	5.9	6.3

Source: Maybank IBG Research, Bloomberg

Fig 3: Philippines: Key macroeconomic indicators

	2022	2023	2024	2025E	2026F	2027F
Real GDP (%)	**7.6**	**5.5**	**5.7**	**4.4**	**4.5**	**4.9**
Private Consumption (%)	8.3	5.5	4.9	4.6	4.2	4.7
Government Consumption (%)	5.1	0.3	7.3	9.1	4.8	5.0
Gross Fixed Capital Formation (%)	9.8	8.2	6.3	0.5	4.1	4.5
Exports of Goods & Services (%)	11.0	1.3	3.3	8.1	5.3	5.5
Imports of Goods & Services (%)	14.0	1	4.2	5.1	5.4	5.6
Current Account Balance (% of GDP)	(4.5)	(2.8)	(4.0)	(3.8)	(3.9)	(3.5)
Fiscal Balance (% of GDP)	(7.3)	(6.2)	(5.6)	(6.1)	(5.8)	(5.4)
Inflation Rate (%, period average)	5.8	6	3.2	1.7	3.3	3.1
Unemployment Rate (%, period average)	5.4	4.3	3.8	4.2	4.5	4.3
Exchange Rate (per USD, end-period)	55.7	55.4	58	58.82	59.50	58.00
Benchmark Interest Rate (% p.a., end-period)	5.5	6.5	5.75	4.50	4.50	4.50

Source: CEIC, Maybank IBG Research

VIETNAM: strategy and macro highlights

Fig 1: Vietnam: market strategy and sector/stock positioning

Market strategy:

- Government targets 2026 GDP growth of +10% vs. 8% as of 2025. This is the first year of a high GDP growth period target committed by the new leadership. The ambitious target is bolstered by strong public investment (approved VND995t in 2026, +31% YoY), administrative reform, and domestic consumption stimulation. As public debt is far below the ceiling, Vietnam has ample room for and large incentive to pursuit a more aggressive fiscal policy. Meanwhile, monetary policy, after being limited in 2025, appears to have larger manoeuvre room amidst Fed's easing cycle.
- Growth engines experienced radical renovations, namely the resolution 68 which promotes private sector and lately, the resolution 79 aiming to increase efficiency of SOEs.
- In 2025, Vietnam reached a trade deal with Trump, under which Vietnamese exports to the US will be subject to 20% tariff, and trans-shipment will be charged at 40% tariffs. In return, Vietnam will remove all levies on US imports. Despite uncertainty around the US definition of "trans-shipment", Vietnam will likely avoid most trans-shipment-related US tariffs, based on Vietnam's export good structure which tilts toward high domestic content products.
- Vietnam can still offset the incremental tariff to retain FDI and continue to attract new investments, thanks to inherent advantages including competitive workforce, existing manufacturing bases and access to a variety of markets.
- Inflation are likely in check for 2026 at 3.7%, **as (i)** transportation and F&B cost are in favourable zone, **(ii)** production and construction, rather than demand boost, will drive growth this year, **and (iii)** 40% of Vietnam imports which are from China is benefiting from the country's ongoing deflation.
- We forecast credit growth to improve to stay at 16%-18% in 2026 vs. 19% in 2025, and a 50bps increase in deposit rates in 1H26 following the 30-50bps increase in 2H25. This interest rate level is still at health level and should not disrupt the on-going economic growth momentum.
- For 2026, we expect earnings of listed companies of the VN-Index to grow 17.5% compared to 20.5% in 2025. Solid earnings growth and the FTSE upgrade theme underpin our VN-Index target of 2,000 pts for the year.

Sector/stock positioning:

- We pick 3 themes for 2026: (i) infrastructure spending & consumption stimulation (**HPG**, **FPT**, **MWG**, **GAS**, **PVS**, **KDH**), (ii) capital market development (**TCB**, **MBB**, **HDB**, **SSI**) and (iii) tourism (**ACV**).
- For now, we are NEUTRAL for some O&G names (GAS, PVD, PVS) on valuation perspective after recent bull-run. Our long-term picks are **VNM**, **SAB**, **QNS** (F&B), **FPT** (IT), **ACV** (tourism), **MWG** (retail), **VHM** (property), **TCB** and **MBB** (banks). Besides, on a bottom-up approach we also like **FRT** (pharmaceutical), **DPG** (real estate), **MCH** (consumer), **VCB**, **HDB**, **STB** (banks).

Source: Maybank IBG Research

Fig 2: Vietnam: stock recommendations

	BBg	Mk. cap	Rec.	Price	TP	Up side	EPS grw. (%)		PER (x)		ROE (%)		P/B (x)		Div. Yield (%)	
	Code	(VNDb)		(VND)	(VND)	(%)	CY25E	CY26E	CY25E	CY26E	CY25E	CY26E	CY25E	CY26E	CY25E	CY26E
Vietcombank	VCB-VN	487,971	Buy	58,400	85,300	46.1	4.6	14.6	15.0	13.1	15.2	15.1	2.1	1.9	-	1.4
Vinhomes	VHM-VN	427,992	Buy	104,200	119,000	14.2	29.3	5.9	10.4	9.8	18.7	16.9	1.8	1.5	0.2	-
Airport Corp	ACV-VN	98,191	Buy	45,100	65,000	44.1	(2.6)	(3.0)	9.8	10.1	15.5	13.0	1.4	1.2	-	-
Masan Group	MSN-VN	110,746	Buy	73,200	108,900	48.8	176.3	38.9	31.1	22.4	8.6	11.4	2.6	2.5	-	1.1
Viet. Prosp	VPB-VN	208,662	Buy	26,300	40,600	54.4	35.0	11.7	9.8	8.8	14.1	14.1	1.3	1.2	1.9	1.9
PetroViet Gas	GAS-VN	199,068	Buy	82,500	86,000	8.2	18.4	7.1	16.4	15.3	17.1	16.7	2.6	2.4	3.6	3.6
Masan Con.	MCH-VN	157,474	Buy	147,500	185,000	30.0	(14.6)	13.9	23.6	20.7	46.4	40.5	8.7	8.1	2.7	4.3
Vinamilk	VNM-VN	129,786	Buy	62,100	88,000	49.3	0.2	8.8	13.8	12.7	29.9	33.9	4.2	4.4	7.9	7.5
Hoa Phat	HPG-VN	202,263	Buy	26,350	37,220	41.3	10.0	28.4	13.6	10.6	12.7	14.3	1.6	1.4	0.0	1.9
Techcombank	TCB-VN	217,597	Buy	30,800	48,000	55.8	15.2	25.5	8.8	7.0	16.1	17.7	1.3	1.2	3.2	3.2
Military Bank	MBB-VN	158,659	Buy	26,000	32,500	25.0	14.7	21.2	8.0	6.6	21.0	21.1	1.5	1.3	1.2	1.9
Asia Com bank	ACB-VN	122,253	Buy	23,800	30,846	29.6	(7.1)	23.2	8.0	6.5	17.1	18.4	1.3	1.1	4.2	4.2
Mobile world	MWG-VN	115,939	Buy	79,200	102,000	30.2	62.3	20.0	19.2	16.0	20.6	21.7	3.7	3.2	1.5	1.9
Vincom Retail	VRE-VN	59,876	Buy	26,350	33,400	26.8	57.4	(14.2)	9.3	10.8	-	-	1.2	1.1	-	-
Sacombank	STB-VN	117,260	Buy	62,200	82,000	31.8	(41.0)	112.0	22.2	10.5	9.3	17.2	2.0	1.6	-	-
Duc Giang Che	DGC-VN	20,786	Buy	54,700	131,300	143.2	17.3	11.8	6.1	5.4	24.0	23.0	1.3	1.1	5.5	5.5
P. Nhuan J	PNJ-VN	37,849	Buy	111,000	153,000	37.8	32.6	19.6	13.4	11.2	23.1	23.8	2.9	2.5	2.6	2.7
Khang Dien	KDH-VN	29,009	Buy	25,850	38,500	48.9	17.1	34.1	27.6	20.6	5.9	7.3	1.6	1.5	-	-
Gemadept	GMD-VN	31,985	Buy	77,200	87,600	17.5	16.5	4.3	22.6	21.7	11.2	12.9	2.2	2.0	2.6	2.6
PetroViet Tech	PVS-VN	21,582	Buy	42,200	38,692	(8.3)	56.1	(13.4)	15.2	17.5	11.8	9.6	1.5	1.4	1.6	1.6
PetroViet Drill	PVD-VN	19,317	Buy	34,750	29,200	(16.0)	40.0	54.2	22.0	14.3	5.8	8.6	1.2	1.1	1.4	1.4
Nam Long	NLG-VN	14,213	Buy	29,300	40,800	39.2	8.7	5.8	20.3	19.2	6.3	5.7	1.1	1.1	6.7	1.7
Digiworld	DGW-VN	9,535	Buy	43,600	53,000	23.6	23.9	19.8	17.3	14.5	17.4	18.4	2.8	2.5	1.8	2.3
Dat Xanh	DXG-VN	10,223	Buy	14,150	26,600	88.0	(12.4)	51.7	40.1	26.4	2.7	3.6	1.0	0.9	-	-
Dat Phuong	DPG-VN	4,767	Buy	40,850	57,300	40.3	(8.6)	0.2	12.6	12.6	15.6	14.4	1.8	1.5	2.6	2.4

Source: Maybank IBG Research, Bloomberg

Fig 3: Vietnam: Key macroeconomic indicators

	2022	2023	2024	2025E	2026F	2027F
Real GDP (%)	**8.5**	**5.1**	**7.1**	**8.0**	**7.2**	**7.9**
Private Consumption (%)	7.9	3.4	6.7	7.2	7.1	7.5
Government Consumption (%)	3.0	4.6	5.8	8.0	7.8	7.8
Gross Fixed Capital Formation (%)	5.9	4.6	7.1	8.7	8.2	8.4
Exports of Goods & Services (%)	4.9	(2.5)	15.5	16.3	11.2	14.9
Imports Imports of Goods & Services (%)	2.2	(4.3)	16.1	17.1	11.4	14.8
Current Account Balance (% of GDP)	0.3	6.0	6.4	5.5	4.2	4.7
Fiscal Balance (% of GDP)	(4.4)	(4.1)	(3.6)	(3.3)	(3.2)	(2.9)
Inflation Rate (%)	3.2	3.3	3.6	3.3	4.1	4.2
Unemployment Rate (%)	2.3	2.3	2.2	2.2	2.3	2.2
Exchange Rate (per USD, end-period)	23,633	24,269	25,485	26,261	26,400	26,500
Benchmark Interest Rate (% p.a., end-period)	6.00	4.75	4.75	4.75	4.75	4.75

Note: Benchmark interest rate refers to SBV's <6 mth deposit rate cap. Source: CEIC, Maybank IBG Research

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